2. ***Legal Responsibility***

Every business has a responsibility to operate within the laws of the land. Since these laws are meant for the good of the society, a law abiding enterprise is a socially responsible enterprise as well.

3. ***Ethical Responsibility***

This includes the behaviour of the firm that is expected by society but not codified in law. For example, respecting the religious sentiments and dignity of people while advertising for a product. There is an element of voluntary action in performing this responsibility.

4. ***Discretionary Responsibility***

This refers to purely voluntary obligation that an enterprise assumes, for instance, providing charitable contributions to educational institutions or helping the affected people during floods or earthquakes. It is the responsibility of the company management to safeguard the capital investment by avoiding speculative activity and undertaking only healthy business ventures which give good returns on investment.

17.05 Social Responsibility towards Different Interest Groups

After identifying the concept and importance of social responsibility of business the various responsibilities that a business has towards different groups with whom it interacts are discussed below. The business generally interacts with owners, investors, employees, suppliers, customers, competitors, government and society. They are called as interest groups because by each and every activity of business, the interest of these groups is affected directly or indirectly.

Responsibility of Business Towards Different Interest Groups



i. Business
ii. Investors
iii. Employees
iv. Government
v. Competitors
vi. Society
vii. Customers
viii. Suppliers

1. Responsibility towards Owners

Owners are the persons who own the business. They contribute capital and bear the business risks. The primary responsibilities of business towards its owners are to

a. Run the business efficiently.

b. Proper utilisation of capital and other resources.

c. Growth and appreciation of capital.

d. Regular and fair return on capital invested.

2. Responsibility towards Investors

Investors are those who provide finance by way of investment in debentures, bonds, deposits etc. Banks, financial institutions, and investing public are all included in this category. The responsibilities of business towards its investors are :

a. Ensuring safety of their investment,

b. Regular payment of interest,

c. Timely repayment of principal amount.

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